



KLE Technological University

ENTREPRENEURSHIP COHORT PROGRAM (E-Co-Op)

Bridging Academic Projects and Innovation Ecosystems

Department ↔ C-SHINE Integration Framework

KLE Technological University

Why Great Projects Die on the Shelf



Projects End at Grading

Hundreds of Minor and Capstone projects completed each year, but lifecycle ends when grades are submitted.



No Identification Process

Departments lack a formal mechanism to flag projects with commercial or IP potential beyond academic merit.



C-SHINE is a new Centre and need get Connected

The innovation center and departments operate in silos with no structured pipeline between them.

Result: *Thousands of hours of applied technical work lost every year — projects that could become products, patents, and startups.*

Build on What Already Exists

WHAT WE HAVE



Strong project output across all engineering departments



C-SHINE with senior director and mentor group



Motivated student teams with working prototypes



Existing academic evaluation infrastructure



WHAT WE NEED

A structured bridge process that:



Identifies high-potential projects at department level



Channels them into C-SHINE's support ecosystem



Provides progressive mentorship cohorts



Creates a clear path to startup formation

C-SHINE : Student Hub for INnovation and Entrepreneurship Centre

Three Progressive Cohorts



COHORT A EXPLORE

Post-6th Semester

Duration: 1 Semester

FOCUS

Technical validation
& market discovery



COHORT B BUILD

Post-7th Semester

Duration: 1 Semester

FOCUS

MVP development,
IP filing, business model



COHORT C LAUNCH

Post-Graduation

Duration: 6–12 Months

FOCUS

Startup formation,
funding, go-to-market

Explore: Validate and Discover

WHO

6th semester students with flagged Minor Projects

WHEN

7th semester (structured as Design Project credit)

SUPERVISION

Department faculty + C-SHINE mentor

GOAL

Validate: Is it a real problem?
Does the solution work?

MILESTONES

M1

10+ customer discovery interviews

M2

Prototype refined with user feedback

M3

Value proposition & market sizing

M4

Review panel presentation

Build: Develop and Protect

WHO

Cohort A graduates + strong 7th semester Capstone teams

WHEN

8th semester (Capstone & Internship aligned with startup)

SUPERVISION

Department + C-SHINE + Industry mentors

GOAL

Build MVP, explore IP protection, business model

KEY DELIVERABLES

- ✓ Working MVP tested with real users
- ✓ Provisional patent application
- ✓ Investor-ready pitch deck
- ✓ Business model canvas

Launch: From Project to Startup

WHO

Graduating teams committed to startup formation

WHEN

6–12 months post-graduation incubation

SUPPORT

Workspace, stipend, mentors, seed funding networks

GOAL

Registered startup, paying customers, investor readiness

CHECKPOINTS

Month 1–3

Company registration, first customer/pilots

Month 4–6

Revenue validation, seed funding applications

Month 7–12

Team expansion, traction

Three-Stage Selection Process

1

Departmental Screening

PIC evaluates using
5-criterion rubric
Threshold: 70/100



2

C-SHINE Vetting Panel

Pitch + Q&A session
Market, scale, team
assessment



3

Milestone Reviews

Monthly check-ins
Pre-agreed targets
Exit if non-compliant

Departmental Screening Rubric

20%

Problem Significance

Real problem with identifiable users/market?

1-5

20%

Technical Novelty

Differentiated approach with defensible value?

1-5

20%

Prototype Maturity

Working demo tested with real users?

1-5

20%

Team Capability

Cohesive, skilled, motivated to continue?

1-5

20%

Commercial / IP Potential

Plausible path from project to product?

1-5

THRESHOLD: Projects scoring 70/100 or above advance to C-SHINE Vetting

C-SHINE Vetting Panel



PANEL COMPOSITION

- ★ C-SHINE Director / Senior Mentor (Chair)
- 🤝 1–2 Industry Mentors (domain experts)
- 🎓 Department Representative (optional)

FORMAT

10-minute pitch + 10-minute Q&A per team

Market Viability

Credible market? Clear competitors?
Unfair advantage?

Scalability

Can it grow from 1 to users?
Architecture ready?

Team Coachability

Open to feedback? Willing to pivot?
Strongest predictor of success.

Annual Operational Cycle



KEY ACTIONS

- ✓ PIC screening & rubric scoring → Recommendation list to C-SHINE
- ✓ Pitch sessions & panel evaluation → Cohort admission & mentor assignment
- ✓ Monthly milestones, workshops, mid-semester review → Demo Day & advancement decisions

C-SHINE Workshop Curriculum (tententative)

COHORT A — Foundations

- ✓ Design Thinking & Ideation
- ✓ Customer Discovery
- ✓ Problem-Solution Fit
- ✓ IP Fundamentals
- ✓ Lean Startup Essentials

Weekly 2-hr workshops

COHORT B — Execution

- ✓ Rapid Prototyping
- ✓ MVP Scoping
- ✓ Business Model Canvas
- ✓ Competitive Analysis
- ✓ Pitch Deck Construction

Weekend bootcamps

COHORT C — Business

- ✓ Financial Planning
- ✓ Legal Structuring
- ✓ Fundraising Strategy
- ✓ Go-to-Market Planning
- ✓ Govt Grants & Schemes

Monthly masterclasses

What Needs to Be in Place



Credit Integration

Cohort A = Project (7th semester)

Cohort B = Capstone & Internship alignment



IP Policy

Student-friendly: 70–80% ownership to students



Industry Mentors

15–20 mentors, 4–6 hrs/month across key domains



Program Coordinator

Dedicated role at C-SHINE to own end-to-end process



Seed Resources

INR 25–50K prototyping budget per team per semester



Physical Space

Co-working area, prototyping labs, meeting rooms

Anticipated Challenges and Solutions

Risk	Mitigation
Low departmental participation	Start with champion departments; PIC service recognition
Student time constraints	Integrate with academic credit (internship, Capstone)
IP ownership disputes	Clear student-friendly policy before launch
Industry mentor attrition	2x mentor bench; structured engagement; public recognition
Weak project pipeline	Maintain scoring thresholds; quality over quantity
Post-grad financial pressure	Stipends; early government grant connections

Recommended Pilot Approach

PILOT SCOPE

- 2–3 departments with faculty champions
- 5–8 teams across pilot departments
- 3–5 industry mentors
- One full academic year cycle

IMMEDIATE ACTIONS

- 1 Secure Dean + department head endorsement
- 2 Finalize IP policy framework
- 3 Form PICs in pilot departments
- 4 Recruit industry mentors & appoint coordinator

THE VISION

In three years, this program can establish the institution as a recognized hub for student-led innovation — producing a steady stream of patents, products, and startups.

The investment is modest.

The process is clear.

The opportunity is now.